



Mostly sunny 77/61 • Tomorrow: Cloudy, breezy 73/51 B18

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, MAY 29, 2026 • \$4



Kristie Nish bartends at American Legion Post 678 in Willowick, Ohio.

MATTHEW CHASNEY/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

In a striking shift, Trump’s approval plunges among working-class base

White voters who propelled him to second term sour on the economy, a poll finds

BY HANNAH KNOWLES

WILLOWICK, OHIO — Just outside the bar where the TV warned of rising gas prices, Dottie Cirino, 64, predicted that President Donald Trump would figure it out. “He’ll get ‘em back down,” said Cirino, part of the White working-class who for a decade formed the core of Trump’s base.

Annette Dombrowski, a 64-year-old janitor at the same factory as Cirino, also voted for Trump. But she was starting to worry. “You could be paying these prices for a while,” she said quietly. White voters without college degrees like Dombrowski, who have powered Trump’s victories since 2016, are growing frustrated

with his second term. In a striking shift, the group that voted to reelect Trump by a huge margin is now net-negative on how Trump is handling his job in several polls. They join other Americans across demographic lines souring on the president’s second term, especially his handling of the economy. The swing is stark: 54 percent of White voters without a college

degree disapproved of Trump’s performance in a CBS News poll this month, up from 32 percent in February 2025 and 45 percent in February of this year. It’s a sobering sign for Republicans heading into the midterms and working to turn out the voters who carried Trump to victory in 2024. Dombrowski said she believed

SEE VOTERS ON A18

DOJ probes nonprofit in E. Jean Carroll case

Statements about who paid her legal bills could lead to perjury charges

BY PERRY STEIN

The Justice Department has launched a criminal probe into a Chicago-based nonprofit backed by billionaire Reid Hoffman over its payment of legal bills of E. Jean Carroll, the advice columnist who accused President Donald Trump of sexual assault, according to two people familiar with the matter. The investigation, which is expected to look at statements Carroll made during a deposition, could also morph into a criminal perjury probe against the 82-year-old columnist, said the people familiar with the matter, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss an ongoing probe. The nascent investigation follows years of Trump publicly deriding Carroll, his accuser, and Hoffman, a major Democratic Party donor. A representative for Hoffman, a co-founder of LinkedIn, declined to comment. An attorney for Carroll could not immediately be reached for comment. The investigation stems from Carroll’s civil lawsuit against Trump, in which a jury found that Trump had sexually assaulted and

SEE CARROLL ON A5



MATT MCCLAIN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Springsteen promises a ‘ruckus’ to come

Bruce Springsteen and the E Street Band perform at Nationals Park on Wednesday evening. Springsteen and guitarist Tom Morello announced a protest music festival for the area set for October. **Stories, B1**

Ex-CIA official is accused of stealing \$40 million in gold bars

BY WARREN P. STROBEL

A former CIA official has been accused of stealing 303 gold bars worth more than \$40 million from the spy agency and stashing them in his Virginia residence, according to a criminal complaint and current and former U.S. officials. Prosecutors say David J. Rush of Virginia, described in a criminal complaint as a former senior

Arrest raises questions about thoroughness of background checks

executive with a top-secret security clearance, also misled his superiors about his education and military service, falsely claiming college degrees he did

not have and \$77,000 in military leave pay he wasn’t entitled to. Rush was arrested last week and charged with theft of public funds. His attorney, Jessica N. Carmichael, declined to comment. While much about the case remains unknown, it raises questions about the efficacy of U.S. government background checks on Rush, as well as how he was allegedly able to persuade his

U.S. and Iran reach a loose framework to end Mideast war

BESSENT: HORMUZ, URANIUM AT ISSUE

Ongoing strikes illustrate tenuous situation

BY DAN LAMOTHE AND GERRY SHIH

The United States and Iran have reached a tentative agreement to end their months-long war in the Middle East, senior officials on both sides said Thursday, but it comes with the major caveat that President Donald Trump and his counterparts in Tehran are reviewing it. Senior U.S. officials acknowledged the framework deal following a night in which U.S. and Iranian forces exchanged drone and missile fire in the region, highlighting the shaky nature of

the ceasefire that was declared in April. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent told reporters at the White House that the tentative agreement is “multifaceted” and awaiting Trump’s potential approval. “He has several red lines,” Bessent said of the president’s review, later adding: “He’s not going to take a bad deal.” Bessent said that “nothing is going to be on the table” until Iranian officials first agree to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, the waterway through which roughly 20 percent of the world’s oil flows out of the Middle East and into the global economy. The Iranians also must agree to turn over their highly enriched uranium and cannot have a nuclear program, Bessent said, points of contention that have scuttled provisional agreements thus far.

SEE IRAN ON A12

Trump appointees push banknote with his face

Federal law allows only deceased people to appear on bills

BY JONATHAN O’CONNELL

Trump administration officials have pressed the office responsible for printing the nation’s money to design a \$250 bill featuring the president’s portrait, according to four current and former employees, in what would be the first appearance of a living person on U.S. currency in more than 150 years. Starting last year, two political appointees at the Treasury Department — U.S. Treasurer Brandon Beach and his senior adviser, Mike Brown — repeatedly urged staff at the agency’s Bureau of



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Legislation would have to be passed for the proposed \$250 bill to move ahead.

Engraving and Printing to prepare prototypes of the note, according to the employees, who said the move raised concerns because federal law currently allows only deceased people to appear on bills. The employees spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of retribution. As part of the effort, Beach in August and September provided

SEE BILL ON A6

In true blue D.C., radio host seeks a toehold in the GOP

BY PAUL SCHWARTZMAN

John Fredericks, the conservative radio host who has built a large following as a cheerleader for President Donald Trump, is setting his sights on a far narrower audience: D.C. voters. Fredericks is on the city’s June 16 primary ballot, running unopposed to become chair of the local Republican Party in Ward 2, an area encompassing deep-blue neighborhoods like Georgetown, Dupont Circle and Logan Circle. The ward also includes the famous address occupied by the man whom Fredericks recently

introduced on his radio show as “the greatest president in, maybe, history.” Why a so narrowly focused political perch would appeal to Fredericks is something of a puzzle for the rarefied few who follow the machinations of D.C.’s local GOP. For more than a decade, the “Godzilla of Truth,” as Fredericks is known on the air, has built an audience of several million on radio stations in states such as Virginia, Pennsylvania and Tennessee, as well as on an array of social media platforms. No one could ever confuse D.C.

SEE WARD 2 ON A8

IN THE NEWS

Mail-in voting A federal judge has allowed an executive order intended to limit who can receive ballots by mail to stand, for now. A8
Death row reprieve The Supreme Court ruled that a Mississippi man should have had the opportunity to challenge the dismissal of potential jurors on grounds of racial bias. A4

THE NATION
JD Vance, in a speech to Air Force Academy graduates, expressed concern about how AI will be used in warfare. A3
Bari Weiss has begun an overhaul of CBS, firing several veteran journalists. A9

THE WORLD
A field hospital for Americans exposed to Ebola is set to open Friday in Kenya. A11
A Russian filmmaker’s condemnation of Putin’s war was applauded in Cannes — and mocked in Ukraine. A12

THE ECONOMY
Amid high inflation and job insecurity, home buyers are giving up hope of mortgage rates falling this year in any meaningful way. A13
A Google engineer who won \$1.2 million from betting on search trends is facing charges of insider trading. A14

STYLE
After an expert Street Fighter player spent weeks in ICE detention, fellow gamers raised \$100,000 toward his release. B1
SPORTS
No. 1 Jannik Sinner goes down in one of the most stunning French Open upsets in years. B7

THE REGION
Human composting is a growing trend among the eco-friendly: For \$6,000, a loved one’s body can be converted into nutrient-rich soil in about a month. B12
WEEKEND
Ten D.C.-area music festivals to have on your radar this summer.

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